



Decision Maker

	Price-conscious	Prudents	Enthusiasts
You need	A reasonably good motherboard that offers integrated video and audio for now, has some upgradeability options for the future	A motherboard that supports the latest and future hardware, offers reasonably good features, performs brilliantly and does not cost a bomb	The latest and the best of them all, loaded to the hilt with features, delivers performance that goes through the roof and you care a hoot about the price
Look for	A motherboard based on Intel 845-GL or 865G chipset for Intel platform, and KM400 or nForce2 chipset based board for AMD platform	A motherboard based on the Intel 865G chipset for Intel platform and nForce2-400 Ultra chipset-based boards for the AMD platform	A motherboard based around Intel's 875P chipset for Intel. For AMD, the Deluxe models based on nForce2-400 Ultra chipset
Our pick	Gigabyte GA-8I865GVMK, Mercury Pi845GLM-L, Krypton NF2400U and Mercury KT400FDSX	Intel-D865GBF, Gigabyte GA-8iG1000MK, ASUS A7N8X-Del and ASUS A7V600	MSI 875P Neo, Intel 875PBZ, ASUS A7N8X-Del, Gigabyte 7NXXP and MSI K7N2 Delta-ILSR
Price	Up to Rs 5,500	Up to Rs 10,000	Above Rs 10,000

heavy I/O transfers, the ASUS A7V600, with its better I/O sub-system, makes a good choice. Also, the SATA controller is native to the VIA's KT600 Southbridge, as opposed to the third-party controllers provided on the nForce2 boards.

Conclusion

Overall, the ASUS A7N8X-Del (Deluxe) is still the performance champion, coming out tops in every test we conducted. The Gigabyte's 7NXXP very nearly beat it, with better performance in the real-world tests, but it fell short by 0.3 units overall. The price tag on the Gigabyte, however, is not justified: even if it per-

forms on par with the best, and has a couple of features more than the ASUS A7N8X, the extra Rs 5,000 is too much to ask—anything around Rs 10,000 would make this board worth buying. The MSI K7N2 Delta did everything right, but was beaten by a better performer. The ASUS A7V600 was the underdog that proved its worth by pulling itself on par with the champions on most of the tests, and beating the pants off them in the I/O tests. Considering the features offered, and the performance it delivers, it's our Best Value winner in the mid-range category. 

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lots to
Distract
you at
Planet Digit



Presented by:

